

**State Employment
Relations Board**

WAGE SETTLEMENT 2023

For Labor Contracts with a start date between January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023



INTRODUCTION

The State Employment Relations Board (SERB) is pleased to present the 2023 Wage Settlement Report. This report analyzes the overall wage increase percentage and other monetary incentives negotiated in Ohio public-sector labor contracts that went into effect between January 1 and December 31, 2023.

REVISION NOTES

There were minimal changes to the format and layout of this year’s report compared to the prior year.

REPORT BACKGROUND & METHODS

In its 33rd year, the Wage Settlement Report aims to inform stakeholders of the latest trends in negotiated wage increases in labor contracts for public sector entities. The goal is to provide statistics for employer and employee organizations and promote orderly and constructive labor relationships between public employers and their employees. This report includes data extracted from negotiated labor contracts from the following public sector jurisdictions:

Government	Schools/Libraries	Colleges/Universities	Special Districts
• State • Counties • Cities • Townships	• School Districts (City, Local, Exempted Village) • Joint Vocational Schools & Career Centers • Educational Service Centers (ESCs) • Commuter/Charter Schools • City & County Libraries	• Community Colleges • State Colleges • State Universities	• Fire & EMS Districts • Metro Housing Authorities • Port Authorities • Regional Transit Authorities • Sanitary, Water, & Sewer Districts

REPORT SUMMARY

This year’s report includes data extracted from 908 negotiated labor contracts with a start date between January 1, 2023, and December 31, 2023.

- There were 786 out of 908 (86.6%) labor contracts with a wage increase percentage during the contract duration. **Table 1** indicates statewide average increase was 3.75% in year one (2023), 3.09% in year two (2024), and 2.93% in year three (2025).
- The statewide average wage increase percentage for the duration of the contracts was 3.24%. This is an average of all wage increase percentages during each contract term, including years one, two, and three, if available. **Table 2** indicates the statewide average wage increase is 0.45% more than what was reported last year.
- There were 129 out of 908 (14.2%) labor contracts with one or more lump sums that took effect during the duration of the contract. **Table 3** indicates the statewide average lump sum was \$1,270 in year one (2023), \$1,160 in year two (2024), and \$1,142 in year three (2025). A lump sum is a one-time dollar amount that is not added to the base wage scale.
- There were 95 out of 908 (10.5%) labor contracts that included an hourly increase that went into effect during the contracts’ duration. A further breakdown of these stats is not included elsewhere in this report due to the low quantity reported.

Negotiated Hourly Increases				
Year	Min	Max	Average	#
Year 1 (2023)	\$0.20	\$5.00	\$1.27	77
Year 2 (2024)	\$0.20	\$2.00	\$0.87	56
Year 3 (2025)	\$0.30	\$2.00	\$0.89	43
#: Number of contracts.				

AVERAGE NEGOTIATED WAGE INCREASE PERCENTAGE

Table 1 displays the average wage increase percentage negotiated in labor contracts that went into effect in the calendar year 2023. The wage increases were grouped by effective date and filtered by each comparison group below. If a wage reopener, lump sum, or hourly increase is mentioned in the labor contract, those are excluded from this table.

Table 1

Average Negotiated Wage Increase Percentage (%) By Calendar Year						
Comparison Group	2023		2024		2025	
	Average	#	Average	#	Average	#
Statewide	3.75 %	669	3.09%	763	2.93%	698
Region						
(1) Akron/Canton	3.85%	106	3.05%	125	2.89%	115
(2) Cincinnati	3.57%	68	3.06%	81	2.89%	69
(3) Cleveland	3.67%	146	2.89%	155	2.77%	145
(4) Columbus	3.66%	99	3.33%	120	3.33%	109
(5) Dayton	3.73%	80	3.07%	82	2.97%	71
(6) Southeast Ohio	3.70%	38	3.22%	47	3.05%	42
(7) Toledo	4.08%	75	3.27%	87	2.90%	78
(8) Warren/Youngstown	3.74%	57	2.94%	66	2.63%	69
Jurisdiction						
City	4.00%	254	3.19%	286	3.11%	271
County	4.20%	108	3.27%	132	2.91%	124
Township	3.97%	61	3.25%	73	2.89%	72
School District	3.12%	215	2.87%	225	2.77%	186
Other	4.02%	31	2.78%	47	2.62%	45
Unit Type						
Police (Safety/Security)	4.29%	202	3.29%	248	3.07%	243
Fire	3.77%	80	3.13%	90	3.00%	83
Teacher (BOE)	3.24%	141	2.88%	137	2.74%	119
Non-Teaching (BOE)	3.01%	85	2.81%	98	2.77%	76
Blue-Collar	4.03%	60	2.99%	68	2.83%	65
Other	3.81%	101	3.16%	122	2.94%	112
#: Number of Contracts. Note: A description of each comparison group is on page 9. Note: 786 out of 908 (86.6%) filed contracts contained a percent increase. Note: Contracts statewide with a 0% increase at any point in the contracts' duration: 2023 = 13; 2024 = 10; 2025 = 13.						

The following four charts are visual representations of the data found in Table 1.

Chart 1 compares the average wage increase percentage for all contracts that began in the calendar year 2023 by years one, two, and three of the contracts (if available).

Chart 1

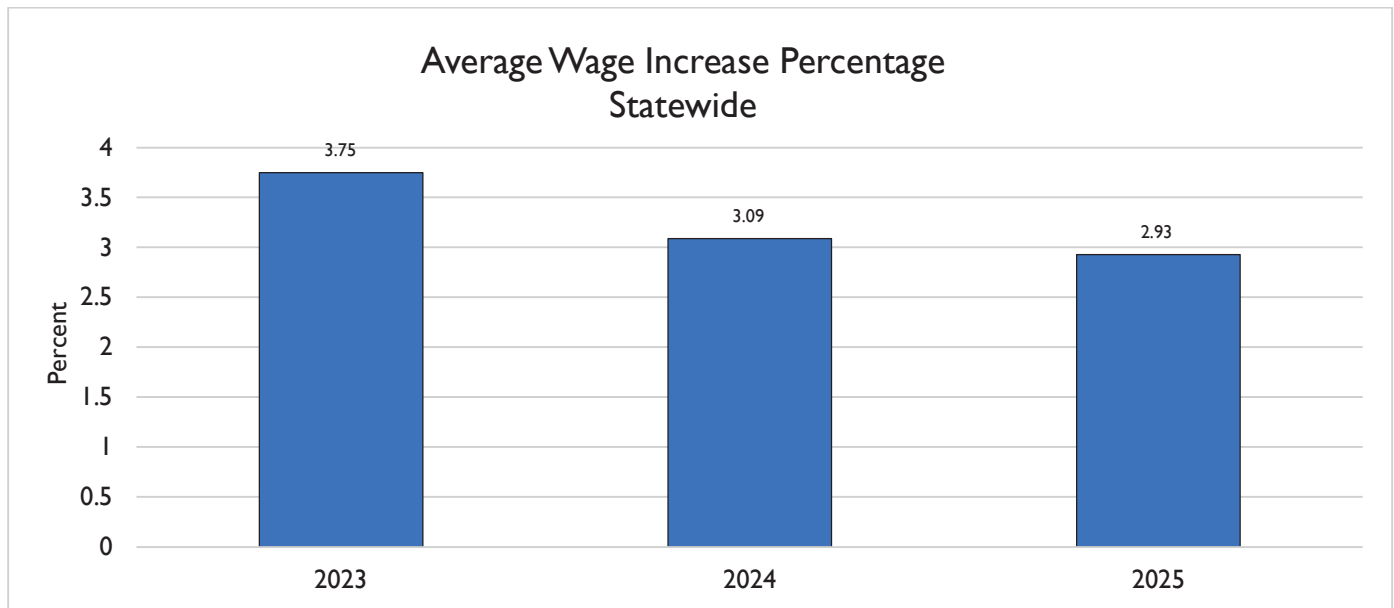


Chart 2 is a visual representation of the region section of the data found in Table 1. Each region consists of several geographically proximate counties. The counties included in each region are listed on page 9.

Chart 2

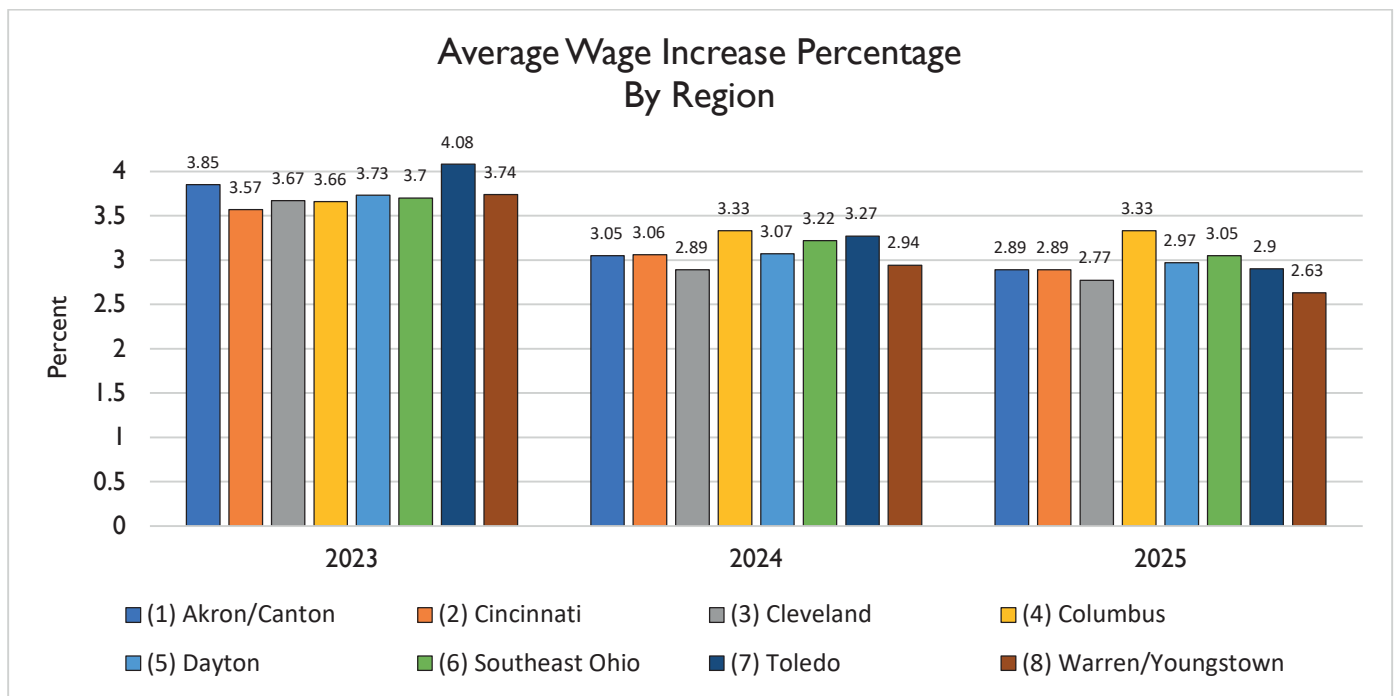


Chart 3 is a visual representation of the jurisdiction section of the data found in Table 1. A detailed list of the employer types included in each group is shown on page 9.

Chart 3

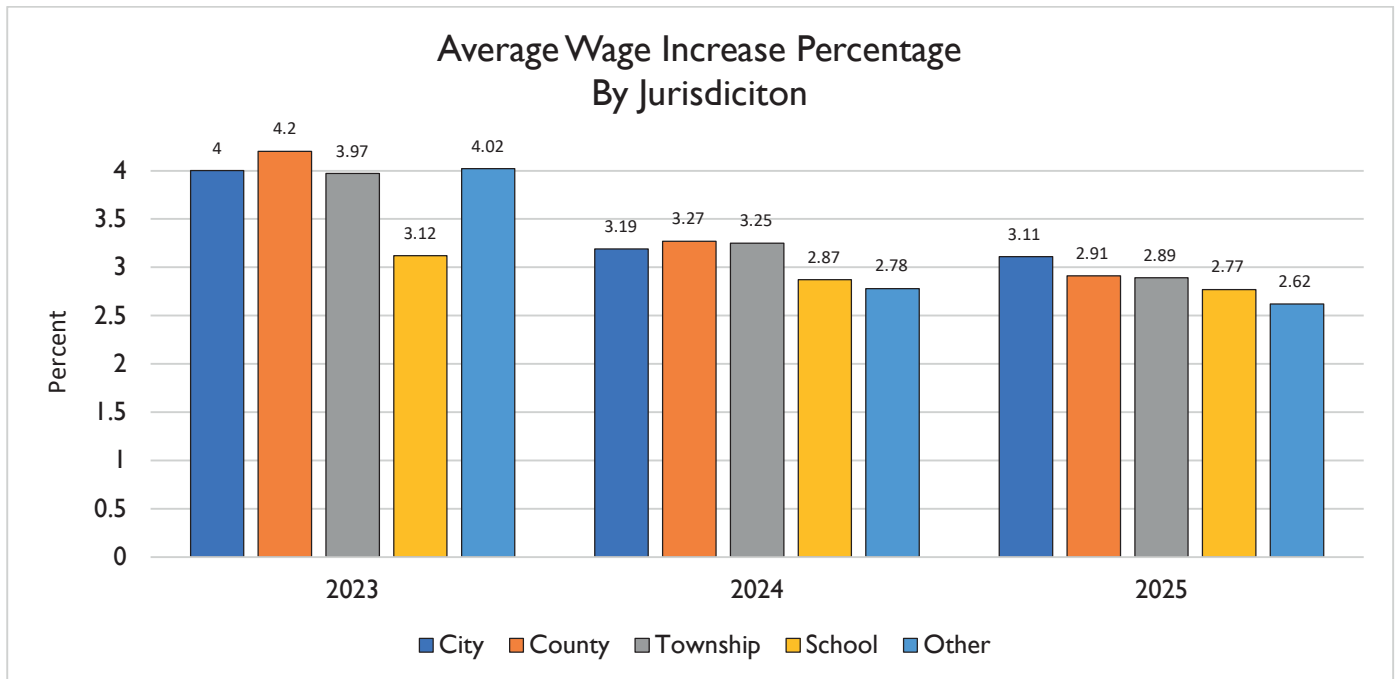
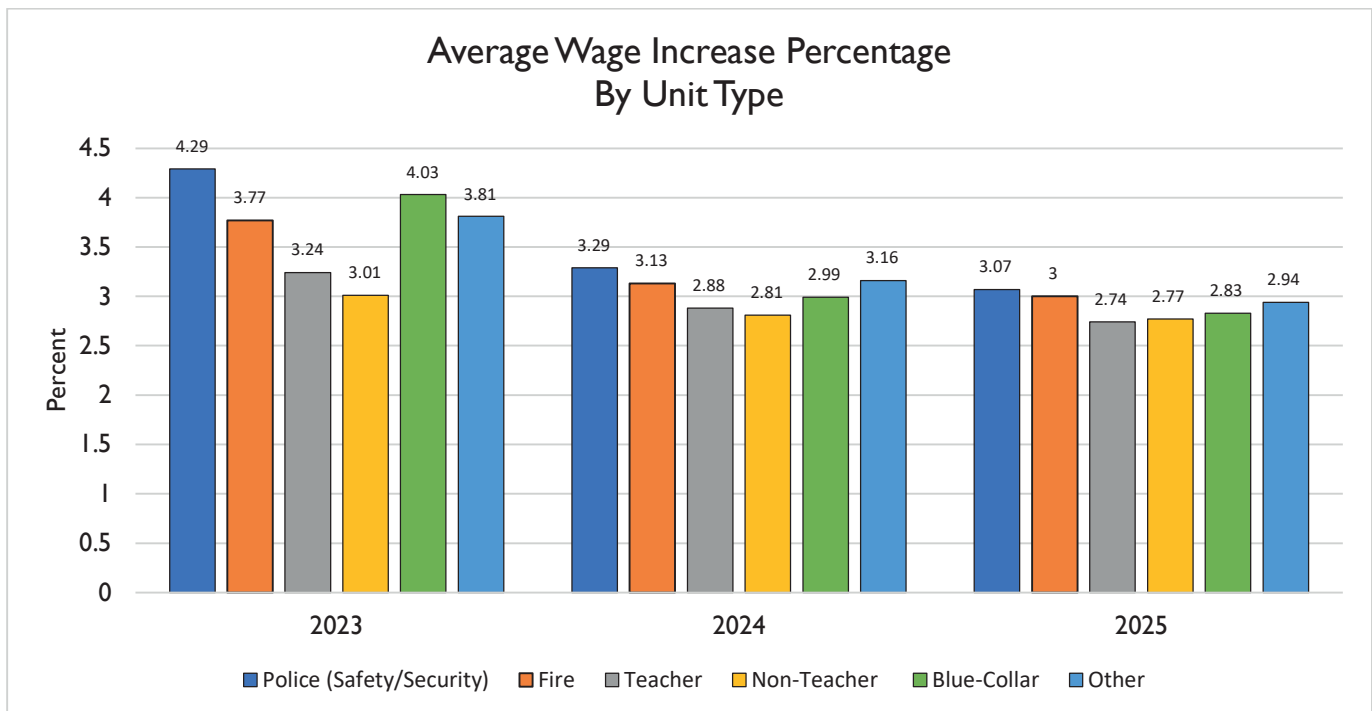


Chart 4 is a visual representation of the unit type section of the data found in Table 1. A detailed list of the bargaining unit types included in each group is shown on page 9.

Chart 4



AVERAGE WAGE INCREASE 10-YEAR TREND

Table 2 displays the average wage increase percentage negotiated in labor agreements for the past ten years. This percentage includes all the percent wage increases that went into effect during the contract duration, including years one, two, and three (if available). If a wage reopener, lump sum, or hourly increase is mentioned in the labor contract, those are excluded from this table.

Table 2

Average Negotiated Wage Increase Percentage (%) Over The Entire Duration of The Contract										
Comparison Group	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
Statewide	1.77%	2.02%	2.18%	2.20%	2.31%	2.31%	2.26%	2.33%	2.79%	3.24%
Region										
(1) Akron/Canton	1.76%	1.89%	2.00%	2.31%	2.24%	2.26%	2.28%	2.25%	2.85%	3.24%
(2) Cincinnati	1.68%	2.05%	2.41%	2.37%	2.63%	2.42%	2.47%	2.41%	2.86%	3.17%
(3) Cleveland	1.49%	1.99%	2.04%	2.15%	2.04%	2.07%	2.11%	2.15%	2.59%	3.10%
(4) Columbus	1.88%	2.19%	2.30%	2.19%	2.63%	2.60%	2.49%	2.65%	2.97%	3.43%
(5) Dayton	1.97%	2.24%	2.20%	2.33%	2.29%	2.55%	2.38%	2.33%	2.92%	3.26%
(6) Southeast Ohio	1.95%	2.07%	2.49%	2.03%	2.39%	2.18%	2.36%	2.61%	2.70%	3.31%
(7) Toledo	1.83%	1.87%	2.30%	2.32%	2.29%	2.25%	2.14%	2.27%	2.87%	3.40%
(8) Warren/Youngstown	1.70%	1.82%	1.61%	1.66%	2.15%	2.16%	1.91%	1.95%	2.56%	3.07%
Jurisdiction										
City	1.92%	2.06%	2.22%	2.16%	2.30%	2.44%	2.47%	2.35%	2.92%	3.41%
County	1.98%	2.12%	2.23%	2.26%	2.33%	2.43%	2.19%	2.37%	2.95%	3.42%
Township	1.88%	1.94%	2.24%	2.22%	2.65%	2.34%	2.56%	2.63%	3.05%	3.34%
School District	1.52%	1.93%	2.09%	2.20%	2.21%	2.17%	1.88%	2.23%	2.52%	2.92%
Other						2.11%	2.43%	2.54%	3.10%	3.04%
Unit Type										
Police (Safety/Security)	2.03%	2.22%	2.36%	2.20%	2.50%	2.51%	2.44%	2.51%	3.04%	3.50%
Fire	1.86%	1.93%	2.34%	2.23%	2.32%	2.41%	2.62%	2.51%	3.01%	3.28%
Teacher (BOE)	1.56%	1.93%	2.04%	2.23%	2.30%	2.17%	1.83%	2.24%	2.57%	2.96%
Non-Teaching (BOE)						2.16%	1.99%	2.21%	2.46%	2.86%
Blue-Collar						2.26%	2.28%	2.29%	2.84%	3.26%
Other	1.69%	1.94%	2.03%	2.18%	2.17%	2.26%	2.26%	2.25%	2.89%	3.28%
Contracts Reported	706	712	496	626	643	811	746	954	943	908
Note: The Jurisdiction "Other" category was added in 2019; therefore, previous reports omitted this information.										
Note: The Unit Type "Non-Teaching" and "Blue-Collar" categories were added in 2019. This data was included in the "Other" category in previous reports.										

The following four charts are visual representations of the data found in Table 2.

Chart 5 displays the historical trend of the statewide average wage increase percentages in Table 2 over the last ten years. These averages include years one, two, and three of each contract (if available).

Chart 5

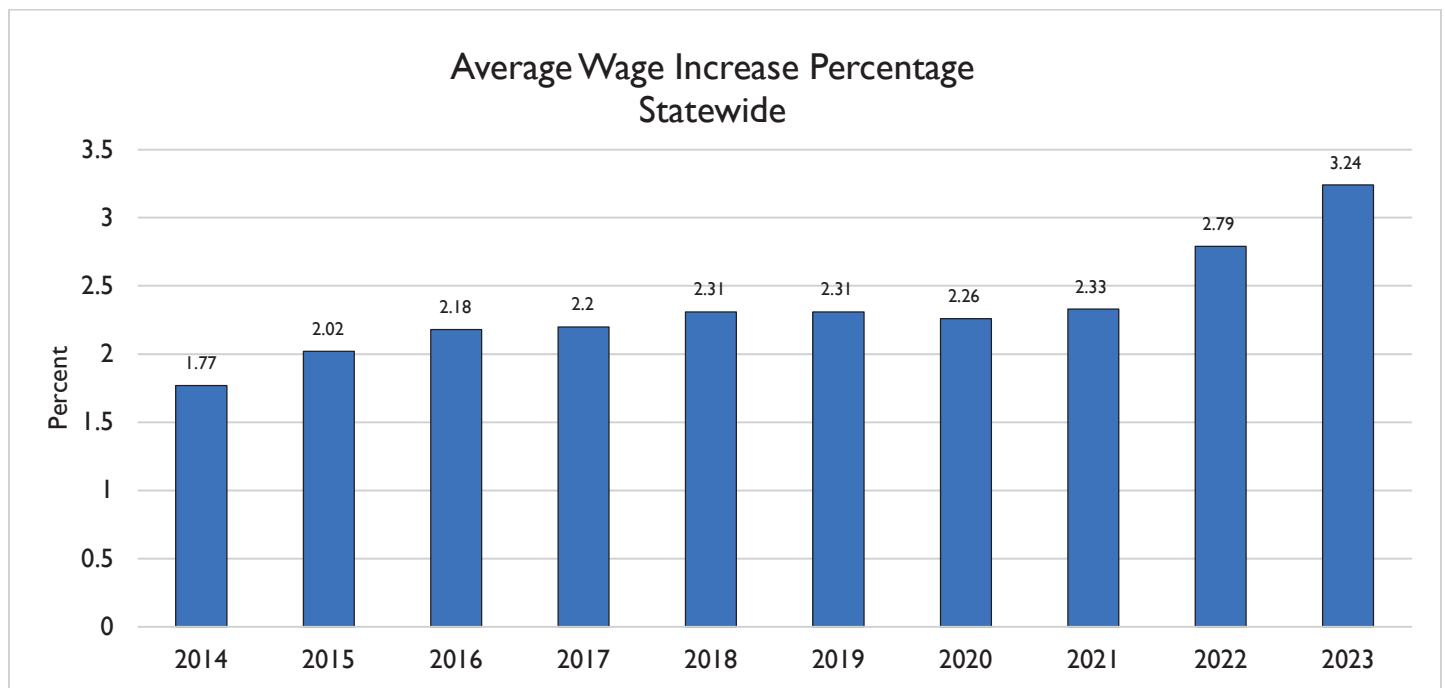


Chart 6 is a visual representation of the region section of the data found in Table 2. Each region consists of several nearby counties. The counties included in each region are listed on page 9.

Chart 6

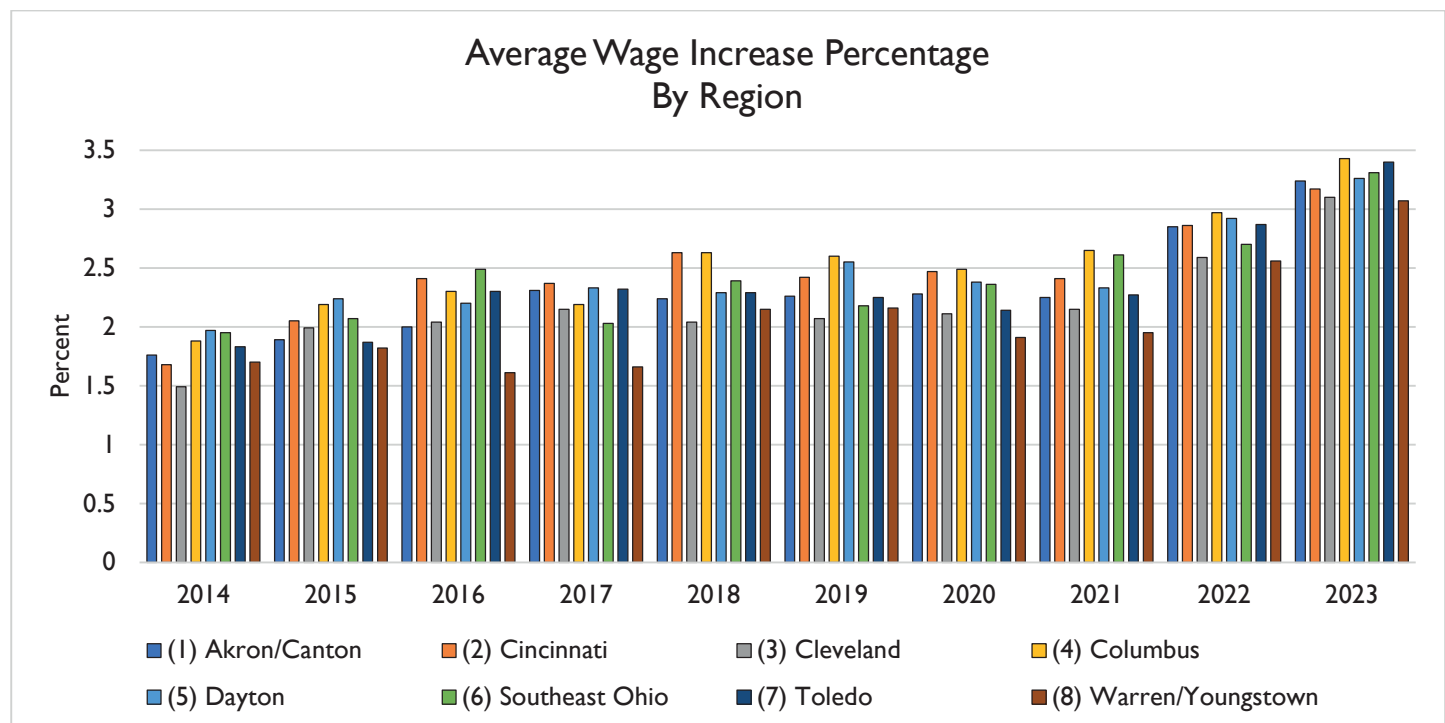


Chart 7 is a visual representation of the jurisdiction section of the data found in Table 2. A detailed list of the employer types included in each group is shown on page 9.

Chart 7

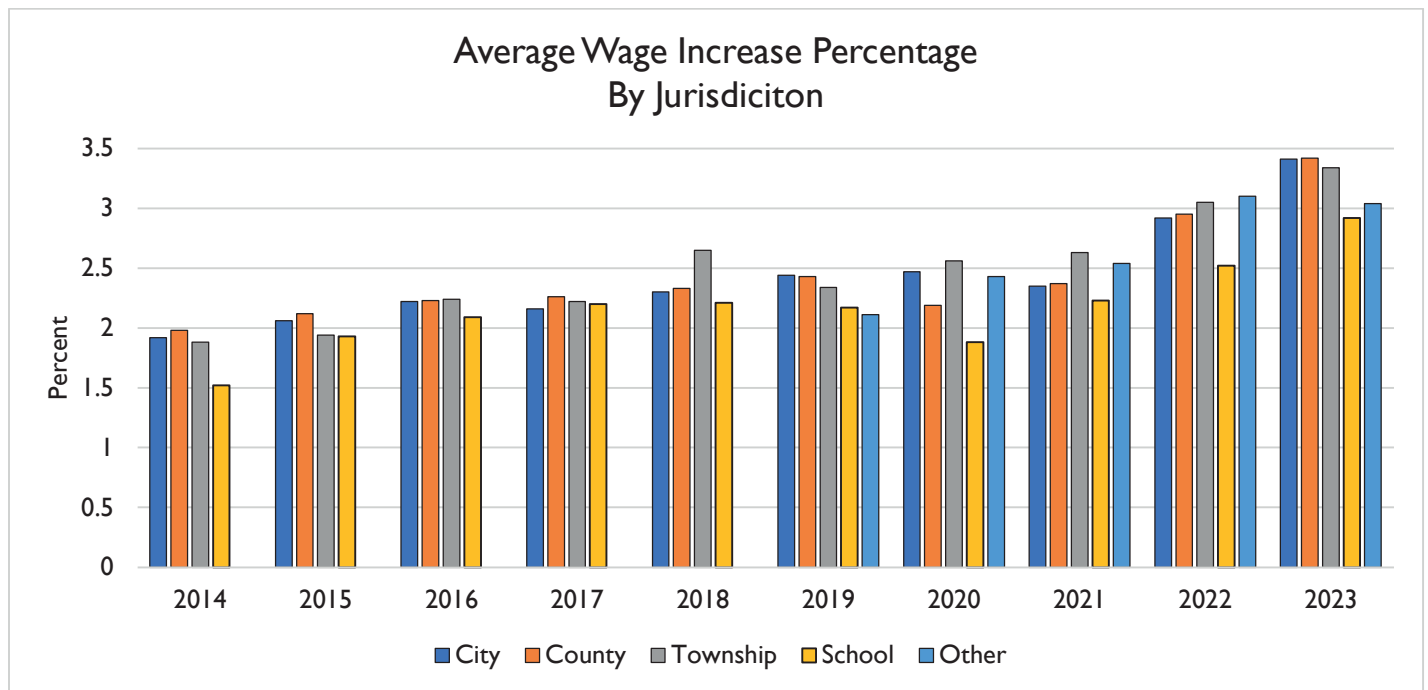
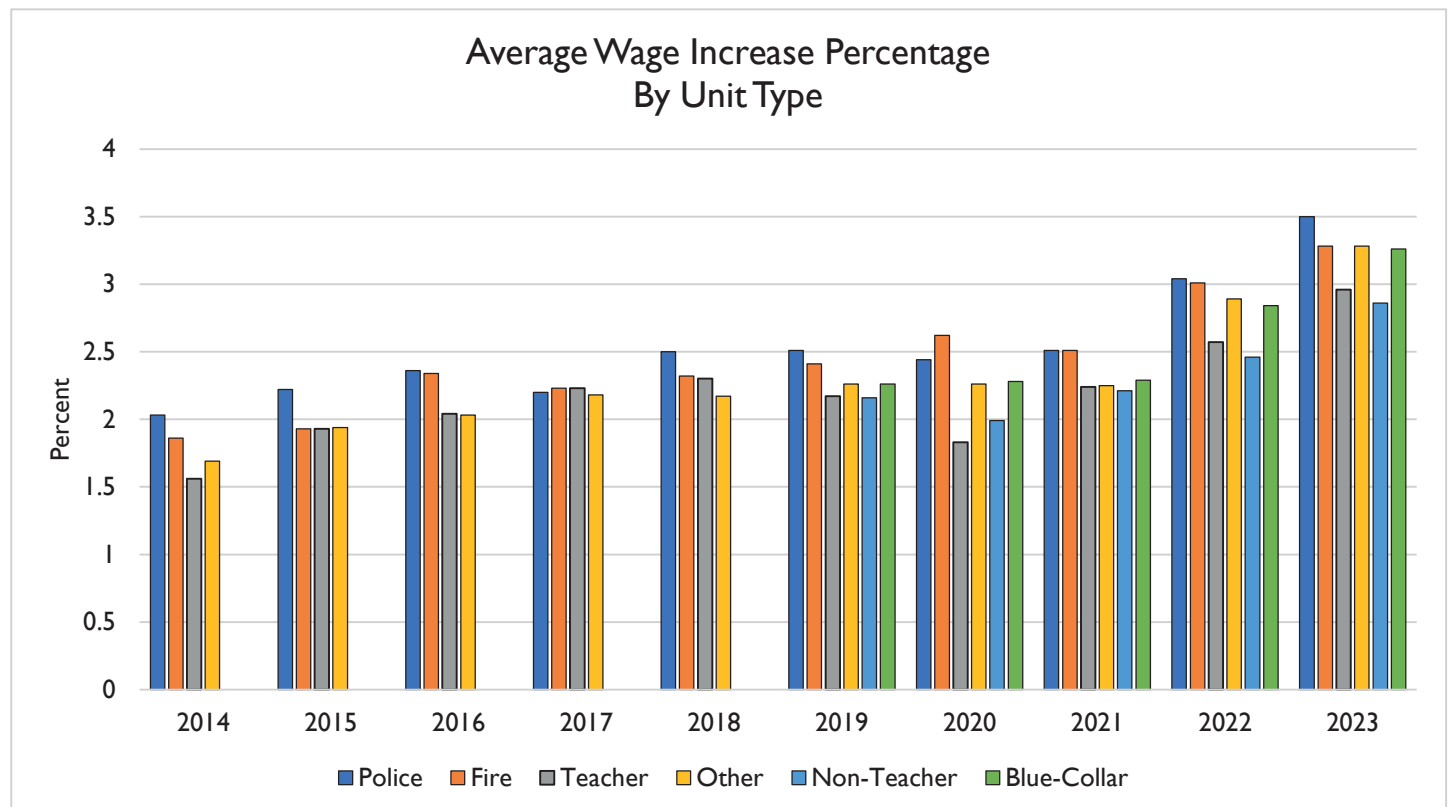


Chart 8 is a visual representation of the unit type section of the data found in Table 2. A detailed list of the bargaining unit types included in each group is on page 9.

Chart 8



LUMP SUM WAGE INCREASES

Table 3 displays the average lump sum negotiated in labor contracts that went into effect in 2023. A lump sum is a one-time dollar amount that is not added to the wage scale. In many cases, this is a signing bonus.

Table 3

Average One-Time Lump Sum (\$) By Contract Year												
Comparison Group	2023				2024				2025			
	Min	Max	Average	#	Min	Max	Average	#	Min	Max	Average	#
Statewide	\$25	\$5,000	\$1,270	123	\$25	\$4,000	\$1,160	35	\$400	\$3,700	\$1,142	27
Jurisdiction												
City	\$250	\$5,000	\$1,557	35	\$500	\$3,700	\$1,537	10	\$500	\$3,700	\$1,734	8
County	\$150	\$4,000	\$1,380	33	\$500	\$3,500	\$2,000	2	\$3,500	\$3,500	\$3,500	1
Township	\$500	\$2,500	\$1,386	7	\$650	\$650	\$650	1	\$650	\$650	\$650	1
School District	\$25	\$4,000	\$892	39	\$25	\$4,000	\$954	20	\$400	\$2,000	\$769	16
Other	\$400	\$4,000	\$1,300	9	\$500	\$1,000	\$750	2	\$500	\$500	\$500	1
Unit Type												
Police (Safety)	\$250	\$5,000	\$1,853	32	\$1,350	\$3,500	\$2,092	6	\$1,350	\$3,500	\$2,092	6
Fire	\$250	\$1,500	\$833	6	-	-	-	0	-	-	-	0
Teacher (BOE)	\$150	\$4,000	\$1,176	25	\$400	\$4,000	\$1,114	11	\$400	\$1,500	\$625	8
Non-Teacher (BOE)	\$25	\$2,500	\$734	20	\$25	\$2,000	\$782	10	\$400	\$2,000	\$913	8
Blue-Collar	\$500	\$3,700	\$1,150	14	\$500	\$3,700	\$1,608	3	\$500	\$3,700	\$1,608	3
Other	\$150	\$4,000	\$1,221	26	\$500	\$1,000	\$630	5	\$500	\$650	\$575	2
#: Number of Contracts Note: 129 out of 908 (14.2%) total labor contracts filed in 2023 contained at least one lump sum. Note: 114 out of 129 contracts (88.4%) with a lump sum contained both a lump sum and a percent or monetary increase.												

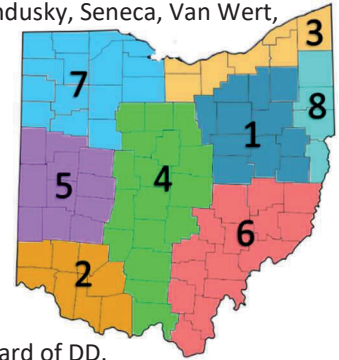
WAGE REOPENERS

There were 37 out of 908 labor contracts filed containing at least one wage reopener. There were 20 wage reopeners in year two and 30 in year three. A “wage reopener” is a way for parties to “delay” their bargaining over wages in future years of the labor contract.

SERB REGIONS

Each region consists of several nearby counties. The county groupings, initially developed by SERB's Bureau of Mediation to develop fact finder and conciliation panels, are as follows:

- 1 – Akron/Canton:** Ashland, Carroll, Coshocton, Harrison, Holmes, Medina, Portage, Stark, Summit, Tuscarawas, and Wayne.
- 2 – Cincinnati:** Adams, Brown, Butler, Clermont, Clinton, Hamilton, Highland, and Warren.
- 3 – Cleveland:** Ashtabula, Cuyahoga, Erie, Geauga, Huron, Lake, and Lorain.
- 4 – Columbus:** Crawford, Delaware, Fairfield, Fayette, Franklin, Knox, Licking, Madison, Marion, Morrow, Pickaway, Pike, Richland, Ross, Scioto, Union, and Wyandot.
- 5 – Dayton:** Auglaize, Champaign, Clark, Darke, Greene, Logan, Mercer, Miami, Montgomery, Preble, and Shelby.
- 6 – Southeast Ohio:** Athens, Belmont, Gallia, Guernsey, Hocking, Jackson, Lawrence, Meigs, Monroe, Morgan, Muskingum, Noble, Perry, Vinton, and Washington.
- 7 – Toledo:** Allen, Defiance, Fulton, Hancock, Hardin, Henry, Lucas, Ottawa, Paulding, Putnam, Sandusky, Seneca, Van Wert, Williams, and Wood.
- 8 – Warren/Youngstown:** Columbiana, Jefferson, Mahoning, and Trumbull.



JURISDICTION

Employers are grouped according to the political subdivision.

City – This includes municipalities in Ohio with 5,000 or more in population.

County – This includes all county-level employers. Examples include County Commissioners, Job and Family Services, Auditor, Recorder, Treasurer, Sheriff, Corrections, Mental Health, and Board of DD.

Township – This includes townships in Ohio with 5,000 or more in population.

School District – This includes City, Local, and Exempted School Districts, Joint Vocational/Career and Technical Schools, and County Educational Service Centers.

Other – This includes all other jurisdictions. Examples include State of Ohio departments and agencies, libraries, regional transit authorities, port authorities, metro housing authorities, fire districts, park districts, water and sewer districts, and colleges/universities.

UNIT TYPE

Below is a list of bargaining units included in each category.

Police (Safety/Security) – This includes bargaining units containing uniformed police officers, sergeants, lieutenants, captains across all jurisdictions, county sheriff deputies, corrections officers, security guards, and park rangers. It also includes safety dispatchers and E911 dispatchers.

Fire – This includes all fire suppression or fire prevention (firefighter) bargaining units.

Teacher (BOE) – This unit type includes teaching and teaching mixed (teaching and non-teaching) bargaining units in public school districts, educational service centers, and joint vocational schools.

Non-Teaching (BOE) – This unit type includes non-teaching bargaining units in public school districts, educational service centers, and joint vocational schools.

Blue-Collar – This unit type includes bargaining units comprised of individuals who perform skilled or unskilled manual labor. These employees do not typically work in an office environment.

Other – This unit type includes all other bargaining units not listed above. Examples include white-collar workers who work primarily in an office environment, nurses, and healthcare workers.



Research Services

What We Do

SERB provides comparable reports of detailed labor provision information extracted from public sector labor agreements.

Available Clearinghouse Reports

Benchmark Report:	Compares annualized entry-level and top-level salaries for more 300+ job classifications. Note: Hourly rate is used for Board of Education non-teaching classifications.
Benefits Report:	Provides an array of economic and non-economic benefit data.
Wage Increase Report:	Shows negotiated across-the-board wage adjustments.
Health Insurance Report:	Insurance data from the survey taken by public employers.
Contract List Report:	Lists collective bargaining agreements on file with SERB.

Available on Website

<u>Wage Settlement Report:</u>	Published March of each year, provides negotiated across-the-board wage adjustment.
<u>Annual Healthcare Report:</u>	Published August 1 of each year, provides public sector insurance statistics.

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About Clearinghouse Database

The SERB Clearinghouse database contains information on all public employers in Ohio and their collective bargaining agreements dating back to 1984. The data extracted from these agreements are available upon request.

Questions?

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